



YEARS 5–6 • TERM BOOK STUDY • NZ CURRICULUM LEVEL 3–4 ENGLISH



Wonder Book Club — Teacher Pack

Reading schedule, every lesson plan, and a curriculum-linked marking guide with a class achievement tracker, for the full 10-week *Wonder* unit.

What's inside

1. Reading & chapter schedule (all 10 weeks)
2. Every lesson plan (Weeks 1–10)
3. Marking guide — curriculum expectations with exemplars (3 levels)
4. Class achievement tracker (one blank table per criterion, with tick boxes)

1 · Reading & Chapter Schedule

How much the class reads, and when, across the term.

Day	Reading range	How it's read
Wk1 Monday	Ordinary → Christopher's House	Teacher reads aloud
Wk1 Tuesday	Driving → Nice Mrs. Garcia	Group reading
Wk1 Wednesday	Jack Will, Julian, and Charlotte → The Deal	Teacher reads aloud
Wk1 Thursday	Home → Locks	Group reading
Wk1 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk2 Monday	First-Day Jitters → Around the Room	Teacher reads aloud
Wk2 Tuesday	Lamb to the Slaughter → Choose Kind	Group reading
Wk2 Wednesday	Lunch → The Summer Table	Teacher reads aloud
Wk2 Thursday	One to Ten → Jack Will (the chapter)	Group reading
Wk2 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk3 Monday	Wake Me Up when September Ends → Mr. Browne's October Precept	Teacher reads aloud
Wk3 Tuesday	Apples → Halloween	Group reading
Wk3 Wednesday	School Pictures → The Bleeding Scream	Teacher reads aloud
Wk3 Thursday	Names (end Part One) → A Tour of the Galaxy (start Part Two: Via)	Group reading
Wk3 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk4 Monday	Before August → August Through the Peephole	Teacher reads aloud
Wk4 Tuesday	High School → After School	Group reading
Wk4 Wednesday	The Padawan Bites the Dust → Breakfast	Teacher reads aloud

Day	Reading range	How it's read
Wk4 Thursday	Genetics 101 → Out with the Old (end Part Two) + Weird Kids (start Part Three: Summer)	Group reading
Wk4 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk5 Monday	The Call → Four Things	Teacher reads aloud
Wk5 Tuesday	Ex-Friends → Fortune Favors the Bold	Group reading
Wk5 Wednesday	Private School → Detention	Teacher reads aloud
Wk5 Thursday	Season's Greetings → The War	Group reading
Wk5 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk6 Monday	Switching Tables → Why I Didn't Sit with August the (end Part Four)	Teacher reads aloud
Wk6 Tuesday	Olivia's Brother → Our Town	Group reading
Wk6 Wednesday	Ladybug → The Bus Stop	Teacher reads aloud
Wk6 Thursday	Rehearsal → The Universe (end Part Five)	Group reading
Wk6 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk7 Monday	North Pole → Lobot	Teacher reads aloud
Wk7 Tuesday	Hearing Brightly → My Cave	Group reading
Wk7 Wednesday	Goodbye → Heaven	Teacher reads aloud
Wk7 Thursday	Understudy → The Ending (end Part Six)	Group reading
Wk7 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk8 Monday	Camp Lies → What I Miss Most	Teacher reads aloud
Wk8 Tuesday	School → Extraordinary, but No One There to See	Group reading
Wk8 Wednesday	The Performance → After the Show (end Part Seven)	Teacher reads aloud
Wk8 Thursday	The Fifth-Grade Nature Retreat → Packing (start Part Eight: August)	Group reading

Day	Reading range	How it's read
Wk8 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Wk9 Monday	Daybreak → The Woods Are Alive	Teacher reads aloud
Wk9 Tuesday	Alien → The Emperor's Guard	Group reading
Wk9 Wednesday	Sleep → The Last Precept	Teacher reads aloud
Wk9 Thursday	The Drop-Off → The Walk Home (finish the book)	Group reading
Wk9 Friday	Quiz day — no new reading	Friday Quiz
Week 10	Final project & celebration week — no new reading	

Each Monday–Thursday lesson runs ~45 minutes: 5 min lead-in, 15–20 min reading, 15 min comprehension/inference, 5 min reflection. Friday is quiz day — no new reading. Week 10 has no new reading — it's the final project and celebration week.

Full term overview

Week	Book section covered	Theme
Week 1	Meeting Auggie	Meeting Auggie, starting school
Week 2	Choose Kind	Settling in, Precepts
Week 3	Halloween	New voices — Via begins
Week 4	Via's World	“The Plague,” Halloween party
Week 5	Jack's Choice	Guilt, loyalty, courage
Week 6	Switching Tables	The school play
Week 7	Growing Up	Via's secret, Daisy
Week 8	Miranda's Secret	The Nature Retreat begins
Week 9	The Ending	The retreat crisis, Awards Day
Week 10	Celebration	Final project & presentations

2 · Lesson Plans — Weeks 1–10

Learning intention, success criteria, reading range, questions, and rubric checkpoint for every lesson.

Week 1 — Meeting Auggie

Learning Intention: We can identify how a character's perspective shapes how a story is told, and infer a character's feelings from what they say and don't say.

Success Criteria: I can describe August's feelings about starting school and give evidence from the text; I can make a prediction based on clues in the story.

Week 1 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Ordinary → Christopher's House | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** If a genie granted you one wish, what would it be — and why? Do you think everyone's answer would be different?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Why does August say he's “not an ordinary kid” but also feels ordinary inside? What does this tell us about the difference between how people see us and how we see ourselves? Why do you think August avoids describing exactly what he looks like?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write 3 sentences about something people might misjudge about you before they get to know you.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** Listen for R1 (inferring August's feelings with evidence) and R8 (predicting/reasoning) during the comprehension discussion.

Week 1 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Driving → Nice Mrs. Garcia | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** How would you feel meeting a brand-new school and brand-new people for the very first time, aged 10?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Why is August's mum being so protective before the school tour? What clues tell us Mr. Tushman is trying to make August feel comfortable?

 **Go-away reflection:** Describe one adult in your life who makes you feel safe when you're nervous, and how they do it.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** Tick off R7 (turn-taking, listening) as groups read together, and R4/R9 from their written answers.

Week 1 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Jack Will, Julian, and Charlotte → The Deal | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** If you had to show a new student around your school, what three things would you point out first?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What is “the deal” Mr. Tushman makes, and why might that be a smart plan — or an unfair one? Compare Jack, Julian, and Charlotte's first reactions to August — what's different about each?

 **Go-away reflection:** Predict which of the three kids will become August's real friend. Give one clue from the text to back up your guess.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** R2 shows well here — comparing how three different characters react gives a clear window into structure/perspective. Watch for R1 and R8 in predictions.

Week 1 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: Home → Locks | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Think of your own first day at a new place (school, club, team). What worried you most?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Why might August feel both excited and terrified on the night before school? What does the “combination lock” scene reveal about how nervous he is?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write a short diary entry as August, the night before his first day.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** The diary entry is a strong R5 checkpoint — look for students writing convincingly in August's voice.

Week 1 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (10 auto-marked multiple-choice, 10 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app "Print Week Pack" for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** Quiz results are your best R6 evidence. Use today to update all of this week's rubric criteria (R1–R10) based on the week's work.

Week 2 — Choose Kind

Learning Intention: We can infer how setting and social dynamics (like seating at lunch) reveal character relationships.

Success Criteria: I can explain why August finds lunchtime difficult and identify the message behind Mr. Browne's precepts.

Week 2 • Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: First-Day Jitters → Around the Room | **Timing:** 5 min • Settle & lead-in • 15–20 min • Reading • 15 min • Comprehension/inference • 5 min • Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Describe a time you walked into a room and felt like everyone was looking at you.

 **Comprehension & inference:** What does August notice first when he walks into the classroom? Why do you think the author includes so much detail about people's reactions/stares?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a rule you'd want a whole school to follow, and why.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** Listen for R1 (identifying what August notices and why) and R8 (reasoning about the author's choices).

Week 2 • Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Lamb to the Slaughter → Choose Kind | **Timing:** 5 min • Settle & lead-in • 15–20 min • Reading • 15 min • Comprehension/inference • 5 min • Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What do you think the saying “choose kind” means in your own words?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What is Mr. Browne's “precept,” and why does he ask the class to write their own each month? Why might “Lamb to the Slaughter” be a scary chapter title for August's first day?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write your own class precept for this month — a short saying about how to treat others.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** R9 shows in the precept-writing task; R7 in how groups take turns reading and discussing.

Week 2 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Lunch → The Summer Table | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Think about your own school's lunchroom. How do people usually choose where to sit?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Why is choosing where to sit at lunch such a big deal for August? What does “The Summer Table” symbolise?

 **Go-away reflection:** Describe a time you sat somewhere new (a table, a bus seat, a mat spot) and how it felt.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** R2 shows well here — the Summer Table works as a symbol, so watch for students unpacking that layer of meaning.

Week 2 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: One to Ten → Jack Will (the chapter) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** On a scale of 1–10, how “bad” do you think a day can really get before it's actually okay again?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Why does August rate his days on a scale of 1 to 10? What does his friendship with Jack Will seem to be turning into?

 **Go-away reflection:** Rate your best and worst school day ever (1–10) and explain why.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** The go-away rating task is a quick R5 checkpoint — look for students explaining their rating with detail.

Week 2 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (6 auto-marked multiple-choice, 14 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app “Print Week Pack” for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** Quiz results are your best R6 evidence this week. Precept-writing across the week is strong R10 evidence too.

Week 3 — Halloween

Learning Intention: We can compare how the same events look different depending on whose point of view we're reading from.

Success Criteria: I can explain why the author switches narrators to Via, and identify at least one new fact we learn about August from her perspective.

Week 3 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Wake Me Up when September Ends → Mr. Browne's October Precept | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What's your favourite thing about Halloween, and why do you think people love dressing up?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Why might Halloween be extra complicated for August compared to other kids?

 **Go-away reflection:** If you designed the “perfect” Halloween costume for yourself, what would it be and why?

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** Watch for R8 as students reason through why Halloween is uniquely complicated for August.

Week 3 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Apples → Halloween | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Have you ever overheard something you weren't meant to hear? How did it make you feel?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What does August overhear on Halloween, and how does it change how he feels about Jack Will? Why is this such a turning point in the story?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a time someone said something (kindly or unkindly) that you weren't meant to hear.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** This is a big emotional turning point — R7 shows in how sensitively groups discuss it together.

Week 3 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: School Pictures → The Bleeding Scream | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** How do you think it feels to see your own photo when you're not happy with how you look?

 **Comprehension & inference:** How does August cope after what happened on Halloween? What does “The Bleeding Scream” costume incident reveal about how people react to August when they don't realise he's nearby?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write a short message of encouragement you'd send August after this tough week.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** R2 — the costume/mistaken-identity device is a strong structure-and-language discussion point.

Week 3 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: Names (end Part One) → A Tour of the Galaxy (start Part Two: Via) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Whose voice do you think we'll hear from next, now that Part One is over? Why might the author want to tell part of the story through someone else's eyes?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What new information do we learn about August's family from Via's opening chapter? How does Via describe her relationship with her brother?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write 3 things you think Via might find hard about being August's older sister — things August might not even notice.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** The switch to Via's narration is a great R5 moment — listen for students writing convincingly from her point of view.

Week 3 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (3 auto-marked multiple-choice, 17 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app "Print Week Pack" for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** Quiz results give strong R2 evidence this week (comparing narrators) alongside the usual R6/R10 checkpoints.

Week 4 — Via's World

Learning Intention: We can identify cause and effect in a story, and explain how a character's actions affect others around them.

Success Criteria: I can explain what “The Plague” refers to and why it affects how other kids treat August's friends.

Week 4 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Before August → August Through the Peephole | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Do you think it's possible to love someone and still sometimes feel frustrated by how much attention they get? Why?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What do we learn about Via's feelings before August was born? How does the “peephole” image work as a metaphor for how Via sees her family?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about someone in your life who takes up “a lot of space” in a good way, and how that makes you feel.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** The peephole metaphor is a rich R8/R2 discussion point even though it's tagged here under thinking.

Week 4 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: High School → After School | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What are you most looking forward to (or nervous about) when you eventually go to high school/intermediate?

 **Comprehension & inference:** How is Via's high school experience different from August's at Beecher? Why might Via choose to keep her old friendships from before secret in some ways?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a “fresh start” you'd like to have and what you'd do differently.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** R9 shows in students engaging with the “fresh start” task and sharing ideas with their group.

Week 4 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: The Padawan Bites the Dust → Breakfast | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection



Lead-in: What's a nickname you have (or would want) and what does it mean?



Comprehension & inference: Why is the “Padawan” nickname significant to August and Jack's friendship? What tension is building at the family breakfast table?



Go-away reflection: Write about a nickname that means something special to you or a friend.



Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8): Watch for R1 — students noticing how the nickname signals genuine friendship, not mockery.

Week 4 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: Genetics 101 → Out with the Old (end Part Two) + Weird Kids (start Part Three: Summer) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection



Lead-in: We are about to meet a brand-new narrator called Summer. What do you predict her connection to August might be?



Comprehension & inference: What does Via learn in science class that connects to her own family? Why does Summer choose to sit with August — what does this tell us about her character?



Go-away reflection: Write about a time you chose to sit/stand with someone who was on their own, or a time someone did that for you.



Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7): A new narrator arrives this lesson — good R5 opportunity in the Summer-perspective go-away writing.

Week 4 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (4 auto-marked multiple-choice, 16 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app "Print Week Pack" for the full student copy and teacher answer key.



Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10): This week's quiz leans on R10 — 'The Plague' is a direct, powerful example for the Choose Kind values strand.

Week 5 — Jack's Choice

Learning Intention: We can explore how guilt and regret motivate a character's choices.

Success Criteria: I can explain why Jack feels guilty and describe what he does to try to make things right.

Week 5 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: The Call → Four Things | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection



Lead-in: Have you ever done or said something you instantly regretted? What did you do next?



Comprehension & inference: Why does Jack's mum make him call August? What does Jack decide to do differently after Halloween?



Go-away reflection: Write about a time you had to apologise for something. How did you feel before and after?



Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8): R8 shows in students reasoning about guilt and motivation — Jack's a great case study.

Week 5 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Ex-Friends → Fortune Favors the Bold | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection



Lead-in: What would you do if your friends started treating your best friend badly — would you speak up?



Comprehension & inference: What happens between Jack and Julian's group now that Jack has changed sides? Why does Jack think “fortune favours the bold”?



Go-away reflection: Write about a time you had to choose between fitting in and doing what you believed was right.



Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9): This is a strong R9 week — the go-away prompt asks students to reflect on real choices they've made.

Week 5 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Private School → Detention | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What do you think it takes real courage to stand up for someone, even if it costs you something?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What happens between Jack and Julian that leads to detention? Why might Jack feel it was worth it?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a moment of real courage you've seen (in real life, a book, or a movie).

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** Watch for R8 as students weigh up whether Jack's actions were “worth it.”

Week 5 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: Season's Greetings → The War | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What does it feel like when a whole friend group takes sides against you?

 **Comprehension & inference:** How does the “war” between groups of kids affect August and Jack at school? What role does social media/texting play in this part of the story?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about the effect that unkind messages (online or on paper) can have, even if “it was just a joke.”

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** Directly relevant to Health & PE / Hauora links — good R10 evidence surfaces here too.

Week 5 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (3 auto-marked multiple-choice, 17 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app “Print Week Pack” for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** Jack's arc this week gives rich evidence for R10 (choosing kind even when it costs you something).

Week 6 — Switching Tables

Learning Intention: We can recognise how small choices (like who you sit with) can carry big social meaning.

Success Criteria: I can explain the significance of “switching tables” and describe a new character's role in the story.

Week 6 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Switching Tables → Why I Didn't Sit with August the (end Part Four) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Why do you think where someone sits at lunch can matter so much in a school?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What does “switching tables” represent for Jack and August's friendship? Why might it take courage to do something so small?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a small action that actually made a big difference to someone.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** R8 — a great chance to discuss how small, symbolic actions can carry big social meaning.

Week 6 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Olivia's Brother → Our Town | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** If you were about to meet your friend's sibling for the first time, what would you want to know about them beforehand?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Who is Justin, and how is he connected to Via? What is “Our Town” and why does it matter to this part of the story?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about someone you've met through a friend or family member who became important to you.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** A new narrator (Justin) arrives — R7 shows in how groups introduce and discuss his perspective.

Week 6 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Ladybug → The Bus Stop | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What's something small and ordinary that has ended up being one of your happiest memories?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What does the “Ladybug” moment reveal about Via and Justin's relationship? How does August's world intersect with Via's here?

 **Go-away reflection:** Describe a small, ordinary moment that turned into a happy memory for you.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** R2 — notice how the story weaves August's and Via's worlds together through small connecting scenes.

Week 6 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: Rehearsal → The Universe (end Part Five) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Have you ever been part of a performance (school play, sports game, concert)? How did it feel leading up to it?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What play is Via rehearsing for, and why might it matter that August will be watching? What does Justin come to understand about August by the end of this part?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a time you were nervous before a performance or big moment — what helped you get through it?

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** Strong R5 opportunity — writing about a real memory of nerves before a big moment.

Week 6 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (3 auto-marked multiple-choice, 17 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app "Print Week Pack" for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** Multiple narrators are now in play — quiz question 19 is great R2/R8 evidence about why the author uses so many voices.

Week 7 — Growing Up

Learning Intention: We can identify how family relationships change and deepen over the course of a story.

Success Criteria: I can explain what Via's “secret” is and describe how August reacts to change within his family.

Week 7 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: North Pole → Lobot | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What's a family tradition you have, and what would it feel like if it suddenly changed?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What does “North Pole” refer to in the family's traditions? Why might August feel uneasy about things changing?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a family tradition that means a lot to you.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** R1 — listen for students identifying August's unease with change and backing it up with evidence.

Week 7 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Hearing Brightly → My Cave | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Do you have a “cave” — a place you go to feel calm or think? Describe it.

 **Comprehension & inference:** What does the “Hearing Brightly” incident reveal about August's confidence/friendships now? What does August's “cave” symbolise?

 **Go-away reflection:** Draw or describe your own personal “cave” — your calm space and why it matters to you.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** A gentle, personal go-away task — good R9 engagement, and R4 in how clearly students describe their own space.

Week 7 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Goodbye → Heaven | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** How do people usually cope with losing something or someone important to them (a pet, a person, a stage of life)?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What loss does August experience in this section? How does he process his grief?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write a kind message to someone who has experienced a loss.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** A sensitive lesson (the loss of Daisy) — keep the tone gentle; R10/empathy evidence is strong here.

Week 7 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: Understudy → The Ending (end Part Six) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Would you rather be the star of a show or the “understudy” who's ready just in case? Why?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What role does August end up playing in Via's school play, and why does this matter so much? What does “The Ending” of Part Six suggest is coming next?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a time you stepped up when someone unexpectedly needed you.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** R8 shows in students predicting what “The Ending” might signal for the story ahead.

Week 7 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (2 auto-marked multiple-choice, 18 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app “Print Week Pack” for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** A big week for family and growth themes — use quiz question 17 (comparing August's confidence since Week 1) as whole-term R1/R8 evidence.

Week 8 — Miranda's Secret

Learning Intention: We can analyse why a character might tell a lie, and predict the consequences of that choice.

Success Criteria: I can explain Miranda's “camp lie” and describe how the setting of the nature retreat builds tension.

Week 8 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Camp Lies → What I Miss Most | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Why do people sometimes tell small lies to seem more interesting or important?

 **Comprehension & inference:** Who is Miranda, and what lie does she tell at camp? What does she say she misses most, and why is that surprising?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a time you (or someone you know) told a small lie and what happened afterwards.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** R8 — a rich chance to discuss why people lie and predict where it will lead.

Week 8 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: School → Extraordinary, but No One There to See | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** Have you ever felt like you did something great but nobody was there to notice?

 **Comprehension & inference:** How has Miranda's friendship with Via changed? Why does the chapter title suggest something “extraordinary” went unnoticed?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a personal achievement that felt extraordinary to you, even if barely anyone saw it.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** A reflective, personal go-away task — good R4/R9 evidence in how students share their own “unnoticed” achievements.

Week 8 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: The Performance → After the Show (end Part Seven) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What do you think it means to finally be honest with someone after keeping a secret for a long time?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What happens during Via's performance? How does Miranda's arc conclude?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about the value of being honest, even when it's hard.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** R10 evidence is strong here — honesty and reconnecting are directly tied to the Choose Kind theme.

Week 8 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: The Fifth-Grade Nature Retreat → Packing (start Part Eight: August) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** If you were going on a school camp for a week, what would you be most excited or nervous about?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What is the Nature Retreat, and why is it a big deal for August? What does his packing list tell us about how he's feeling?

 **Go-away reflection:** Make a packing list for your ideal school camp, and explain your top 3 must-haves.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** August's own narration returns here — R5 shows in how students capture his voice and nerves in writing.

Week 8 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (2 auto-marked multiple-choice, 18 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app "Print Week Pack" for the full student copy and teacher answer key.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10):** Miranda's arc gives a strong contrast for R8/R10 — compare her way of coping (lying) with Jack's (owning up) from Week 5.

Week 9 — The Ending

Learning Intention: We can identify the climax of a story and reflect on how a character has changed from the beginning to the end.

Success Criteria: I can describe the crisis at the retreat and explain how the community responds; I can summarise the key message of the book's ending.

Week 9 · Monday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Daybreak → The Woods Are Alive | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** What's the scariest or most exciting thing that could happen on a night camp-out in the woods?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What tension is building as the kids settle in for the night at camp? Why might unfamiliar surroundings make everyone (not just August) feel uneasy?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a time you felt genuinely scared, and how you (or someone) helped calm things down.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R3, R8):** R8 shows in students noticing how the author builds tension before the climax.

Week 9 · Tuesday — Group Read

Reading range: Alien → The Emperor's Guard | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** If your group of friends were suddenly in danger, what do you think you'd do?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What frightening event happens to August and his friends in the woods? How do the other boys (including some who weren't his friends before) react?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write about a moment when someone unexpected stood up for you, or you stood up for someone else.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R7, R9):** The story's climax — strong R7/R10 evidence in how groups discuss loyalty and standing up for others.

Week 9 · Wednesday — Teacher Read

Reading range: Sleep → The Last Precept | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** How do you think a scary shared experience might change how a group of people see each other afterwards?

 **Comprehension & inference:** How does the school community respond once everyone is safe? What is “The Last Precept,” and how does it sum up the whole book's message?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write your own “last precept” — the one big lesson you'd want people to remember from this book.

 **Rubric checkpoint (R1, R2, R8):** A key thematic moment — excellent R10 checkpoint as students write their own “last precept.”

Week 9 · Thursday — Group Read

Reading range: The Drop-Off → The Walk Home (finish the book) | **Timing:** 5 min · Settle & lead-in · 15–20 min · Reading · 15 min · Comprehension/inference · 5 min · Go-away reflection

 **Lead-in:** How do you think August's very first day of school (Week 1) compares to how his year is ending now?

 **Comprehension & inference:** What happens at the Awards ceremony? Why is it meaningful that the whole community — not just August's family — celebrates him by the end? What does the final chapter, “The Walk Home,” suggest about how far August (and everyone around him) has come?

 **Go-away reflection:** Write a full reflection: What is the biggest lesson “Wonder” has taught you about kindness, courage, or seeing people for who they really are?

 **Rubric checkpoint (R4, R5, R7):** The book finishes today — this final reflection is your best whole-unit R1–R10 evidence, especially R5 and R10.

Week 9 · Friday — Quiz Day

Timing: 5 min recap · 25 min quiz · 10 min review answers · 5 min project check-in

20 questions covering all four reading chunks this week (2 auto-marked multiple-choice, 18 open-answer/self-checked). See the in-app "Print Week Pack" for the full student copy and teacher answer key.



Rubric checkpoint (R2, R6, R10): This is the final book quiz — use it (and Q17, which asks students to compare their Week 1 understanding) to update the whole class's R1–R10 rubric before Week 10's final project.

Week 10 — Final Project & Celebration overview

Learning Intention: We can apply everything we've learned across the term about character, perspective, and kindness to create and present an original piece of work.

Success Criteria: I can plan, produce and present a final project that shows deep understanding of Wonder's characters and themes; I can give and receive kind, specific feedback.

Final project options (student choice):

- **“Choose Kind” Campaign.** Design and pitch a whole-school kindness campaign (posters, a short video script, a pledge wall) inspired by the book's precepts.
- **Wonder the Musical/Play — Extended Scene.** Write and perform an extended dramatic scene (5+ minutes) either continuing the story or dramatising a moment from a new narrator's point of view (e.g. Julian, told with empathy).
- **Character Case File.** Create an in-depth multimedia profile (poster + written report + comic panels) tracking one character's journey and change across the whole book, using evidence/quotes (paraphrased, not copied) from every part they appear in.
- **“Precepts for Our Class” Book.** Design and illustrate an original class book of 12 precepts (one per month of the year), each with an illustration and a real-life example of how to live it out — bound into a class anthology.

Week 10 · Monday — Lesson 1 — Choose & Plan

Choose your project, plan (storyboard/outline), gather resources, and assign group roles.

Week 10 · Tuesday — Lesson 2 — Main Production

Main production time — writing, drawing, rehearsing, building.

Week 10 · Wednesday — Lesson 3 — Finishing Touches

Finishing touches, rehearsal/polish, prepare for presenting.

Week 10 · Thursday — Presentation / Gallery Walk Day

Students present or display their final projects. Peer feedback using simple “Glow & Grow” sticky notes (one thing that shone, one thing to consider next time).

Week 10 · Friday — Celebration & Whole-Unit Reflection — “Choose Kind Day”

No quiz this week. Whole-class reflection circle: share one precept students will carry forward. Certificates presented. Optional: watch/discuss the book's key themes, share favourite moments from the term.

3 · Marking Guide — Curriculum Expectations & Exemplars

How to use this guide: Each of the 10 criteria below is drawn from the NZ Curriculum alignment for this unit (Listening/Reading/Viewing, Speaking/Writing/Presenting, Key Competencies, and Values). For each one, mark students against just three levels — **Not Achieved**, **Working Towards**, or **Achieved** — using the example description in each column as your guide to what that actually looks like from a student. You don't need to judge every criterion every week: each lesson plan above flags which 2–3 codes it gives the best evidence for.

R1 — Understanding ideas in the text		
LISTENING, READING & VIEWING — IDEAS		
Curriculum expectation: Shows understanding of ideas within, across, and beyond texts (NZC Level 3–4).		
NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Retells simple events from the story but cannot identify a character's feelings or the ideas behind them, even with prompting.	Identifies a character's feelings or a key idea with some prompting, but explanations are vague or not clearly linked to evidence from the text.	Clearly identifies characters' feelings, motivations and ideas within, across and beyond the text, and supports this with specific evidence — e.g. explains why August feels “ordinary” inside despite how others see him, using a direct example from the chapter.

R2 — How the text is shaped

LISTENING, READING & VIEWING — STRUCTURE & LANGUAGE

Curriculum expectation: Shows understanding of how texts are shaped for different purposes and audiences (NZC Level 3–4).

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Does not notice or comment on how the story is structured (e.g. chapter titles, multiple narrators), even when asked directly.	Notices an obvious structural feature (e.g. that Via narrates Part Two) but cannot yet explain why the author made that choice.	Explains how the author's choices — multiple narrators, chapter titles, changing points of view — shape the reader's understanding, e.g. explains why seeing events through Via's eyes changes what we know about August's family.

R3 — Comprehension strategies

LISTENING, READING & VIEWING — PROCESSES & STRATEGIES

Curriculum expectation: Integrates sources of information, processes, and strategies confidently to identify, form and express ideas (NZC Level 3–4).

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Rarely predicts or questions the text; needs the answer given rather than working it out.	Makes simple predictions or asks questions about the text, but these are not always well reasoned or linked to clues in the story.	Confidently uses prediction, inference and questioning to build understanding, e.g. predicts which character will become August's real friend and backs it up with a specific clue from the text.

R4 — Communicating ideas

SPEAKING, WRITING & PRESENTING — IDEAS

Curriculum expectation: Selects, forms, and communicates ideas on a range of topics (NZC Level 3–4).

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Written or spoken responses are very brief, off-topic, or do not answer the question asked.	Shares an idea in response to a question, but it is underdeveloped or only partly relevant.	Selects and communicates a clear, relevant idea in response to questions and discussion, developing it with detail or reasoning, e.g. writes a well-developed go-away reflection that stays on topic and includes personal detail.

R5 — Using language features

SPEAKING, WRITING & PRESENTING — STRUCTURE & LANGUAGE

Curriculum expectation: Shows understanding of language features, using them appropriately (NZC Level 3–4).

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Writing shows little control of vocabulary, voice or sentence structure appropriate to the task, e.g. cannot write convincingly “in character.”	Attempts to use appropriate vocabulary or voice (e.g. writing as August or Via) but this is inconsistent through the piece.	Uses vocabulary, voice and sentence structure appropriate to the task — e.g. writes a diary entry convincingly in a character's voice, sustained through the whole piece.

R6 — Communicating with confidence

SPEAKING, WRITING & PRESENTING — PROCESSES & STRATEGIES

Curriculum expectation: Selects and uses processes and strategies to communicate confidently (NZC Level 3–4).

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Struggles to complete written tasks (e.g. the Friday quiz) independently and with confidence, even with support.	Completes most written tasks and quiz questions but needs some support or reassurance to finish confidently.	Plans, drafts and completes written tasks and quiz responses independently and confidently, including under timed/quiz conditions.

R7 — Working with others

KEY COMPETENCY — RELATING TO OTHERS

Curriculum expectation: Listens, takes turns and responds respectfully during group reading and discussion.

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Struggles to take turns or listen respectfully during group reading; often distracts or disengages the group.	Takes turns and listens most of the time, but sometimes needs a reminder to include others or stay on task.	Consistently listens, takes turns fairly and responds respectfully to others' ideas during group reading and discussion.

R8 — Critical & creative thinking

KEY COMPETENCY — THINKING

Curriculum expectation: Asks questions, makes predictions and reasons through inference tasks.

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Rarely asks questions or offers reasoning; accepts the first idea given without thinking further.	Sometimes asks questions or offers a reasoned idea, but doesn't always explain the thinking behind it.	Regularly asks thoughtful questions, makes reasoned predictions and explains their thinking clearly during inference tasks.

R9 — Taking part

KEY COMPETENCY — PARTICIPATING & CONTRIBUTING

Curriculum expectation: Completes tasks, contributes to group work and engages with weekly projects.

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Rarely completes tasks or contributes to group work or the weekly project without significant prompting.	Completes most tasks and contributes to group work/projects, but engagement is inconsistent.	Reliably completes tasks, contributes ideas to group work and engages fully with the weekly project menu.

R10 — “Choose Kind” values

VALUES — DIVERSITY, INCLUSION, EMPATHY, RESPECT

Curriculum expectation: Shows empathy and makes connections to kindness/inclusion themes in discussion and writing.

NOT ACHIEVED	WORKING TOWARDS	ACHIEVED
Rarely makes connections to kindness/inclusion themes in discussion or writing; shows little empathy for characters different from themselves.	Sometimes makes a connection to the “Choose Kind” theme, but empathy or insight is surface-level, e.g. states a character is “sad” without explaining why.	Consistently shows empathy and makes thoughtful connections between the book’s kindness/inclusion themes and real life, both in discussion and in writing.

4 · Class Achievement Tracker

How to use this tracker: Write your students' names down the left-hand column (photocopy extra rows or an extra copy of a page if your class is larger than 28), then tick the box that matches what you've observed for that criterion — **Not Achieved**, **Working Towards**, or **Achieved** — as the term progresses. Use it alongside the exemplars in Section 3 so marking stays quick and consistent between criteria.

R1 — Understanding ideas in the text

Listening, Reading & Viewing — Ideas

[illegible]

[illegible]

R2 — How the text is shaped

Listening, Reading & Viewing — Structure & Language

[illegible]

[illegible]

R3 — Comprehension strategies

Listening, Reading & Viewing — Processes & Strategies

[illegible]

[illegible]

R4 — Communicating ideas

Speaking, Writing & Presenting — Ideas

[illegible]

[illegible]

R5 — Using language features

Speaking, Writing & Presenting — Structure & Language

[illegible]

[illegible]

R6 — Communicating with confidence

Speaking, Writing & Presenting — Processes & Strategies

[illegible]

[illegible]

R7 — Working with others

Key Competency — Relating to Others

[illegible]

[illegible]

R8 — Critical & creative thinking

Key Competency — Thinking

[illegible]

[illegible]

R9 — Taking part

Key Competency — Participating & Contributing

[illegible]

[illegible]

R10 — “Choose Kind” values

Values — Diversity, Inclusion, Empathy, Respect

[illegible]

Student name	Not Achieved	Working Towards	Achieved
	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐

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